ii. from rural to urban,
iii. from the unorganised sector to the organised,
iv. from school to work, and
v. from subsistence self-employment to wage employment.

Several countries have benefited greatly from focused programmes on skilling the workforce on the job, including Japan, US, UK, and Germany. Germany, in particular, has a well-known dual education system that combines classroom/online courses at a vocational school with workplace experience at a company. School authorities are responsible for the former while the company is responsible for the latter. More than 75 per cent of Germans below the age of 22 have attended an apprenticeship programme. Training apprentices also benefits corporates. The UK Task Force Report on Apprentices in 2005, demonstrated that the benefits of apprenticeships were numerous, including – i).increased productivity, ii). lower net costs of training (versus training non-apprentices), iii). greater staff retention, and iv). a more highly motivated workforce.

2. Things India Have

The apprenticeship programmes in India are governed by The Apprentice Act 1961 and the Apprenticeship Rules 1992. The organisational structure and rules and regulations overseeing it are complex and burdensome. The Ministry of Labour and Employment oversees ‘trade apprentices’ through six regional offices. The Ministry of Human Resource Development oversees ‘graduate, technician, and technician (vocational) apprentices’ through four boards located in different cities. There are strict norms on permissions, trades permitted, training duration, stipend levels, apprentice/employee ratio, and training facilities. It is onerous to create new apprenticeship positions, and there are several vacancies even in positions that have already been created. As a consequence, India only has under 3,00,000 formal apprentices.

To ensure that comparier do not hire cheap labour in guise of an apprenticeship programme, the regulatory norms were kept tighter. The need of the time is to develop set of provisions streamlining regulation and